

(b) Status and role

(10 Marks)

Ralph Linton in "The Study of Man (1936)"

first gave the distinction between status and role

① STATUS : refers to the rank a person has in the social hierarchy

[IMPORTANCE] → ensures access to resources, power and authority

g - leopard skin chief in Nauru } High Status
- priests and shamans

[TYPES]

ASCRIBED

- Based on birth
- involuntary, can't join / leave
- Regressive as makes a society stagnant
- Hinders social mobility

g] caste based

ACHIEVED

- based on merit
- can be joined / left
- Enhances social mobility and ensures equality of opportunity

g] Doctor, lawyers

eg] Dr Ambedkar was a — Dalit (Ascribed)
 \ Lawyer (Achieved)

① ROLE : These are the expected functions that a particular status demands

eg] A chief in chiefdom has a role to — ensure social order
 — mediate disputes

IMPORTANCE — Brings ORDER and predictability in society (eg - doctor treats patients)

— Structural functionalists believe that roles are essential to maintain social structure and stability

eg — police has a role to ensure law/order

RELATED — Role reperformance : All roles by a person
 — Role conflict : clashing demands from different roles eg: Women's role as housewife and at her job.

CONTEMPORARY Rise in role conflicts.

Marks:

Comment:

Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total:

Call us: 8826486658, 8826496658

Visit us : www.LevelupIAS.com